



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Mount Tabor School of the Liberal Arts

School Website: <https://mounttaborschool.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: CLASSICAL

Executive Summary

Mount Tabor School of the Liberal Arts (Kansas City, MO) presents a robust classical education anchored in Orthodox Christian faith. Public materials consistently frame the school as a liberal-arts, classical program with explicit religious foundations, a clear sense of formation over mere information, and a pedagogy that blends contemplative elements with Socratic inquiry. The curriculum foregrounds the liberal arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), engagement with classical texts, and a liturgical, communally oriented life. Across categories, the school demonstrates strong Classical indicators, with Element 4 (Pedagogy) representing the area of relative nuance where the school shows both classical (Socratic discourse, rhetoric) and non-classical elements (some emphasis on structured schedules and liturgical life) that suggest it is best described as CLASSICAL with a notable Somewhat Classical element in pedagogy.

Key indicators across the six classical categories:

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: Strong. Orthodox Christian framing, liturgical worship, and directed spiritual formation are explicit. Evidence includes parish affiliation, weekly liturgy, and spiritual readings tied to saints and Church Fathers.
- Purpose and Goal: Strong. Emphasis on formation, virtue, wisdom, and lifelong character shaped within a Christian, classical framework; explicit statements about forming leaders and keeping the faith.
- Curriculum: Strong. Liberal arts core (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and Greek immersion; explicit reference to classical texts, Great Books/Conversations flavor via "Encounter the Classics" language and "great conversation" framing in the materials.
- Pedagogy: Mixed but convergent with classical norms. Socratic discussion in upper grades and rhetoric training referenced; lower grades feature a communal, liturgical life that aligns with scholastic-like elements rather than pure restfulness in every instance. Overall, pedagogy leans CLASSICAL with some non-traditional scheduling and liturgical components.
- Faculty: Strong. Leadership and staff pages show a team of committed, mission-aligned teachers and administrators; the staff is positioned as the living curriculum and core of the school, with a parish-centered identity.
- Parents & Community: Strong. Emphasizes partnership with parents, liturgical participation, and communal life anchored in parish life; parent involvement is framed as an ongoing, welcomed element of school life.

Overall aggregate: CLASSICAL. The school demonstrates the hallmarks of classical education—rooted in truth, goodness, beauty, and formation—within an Orthodox Christian framework, with explicit liberal-arts coursework, Great Books-oriented emphasis, and Socratic pedagogy in the upper grades.

Executive summaries by category (category-by-category snapshot below provides evidence, keyword analysis, and justification for the rating) are followed by a section on what would move the needle if needed and

an # ABSTRACT at the end.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school presents itself as “Kansas City’s only K-12 school in the Orthodox Christian tradition” and operates as a parish school connected to St. Mary of Egypt Orthodox Church, indicating a theologically grounded foundation.
- Public materials describe liturgical life and communal worship (weekly Wednesday liturgy; sacred music in Choir class).
- Spiritual formation is embedded in daily practices (prayer, readings from saints and Church Fathers, Holy Scripture).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords found: theology, liturgy, liturgical worship, prayer, sacred music, chant, Church Fathers, saints, Holy Scripture, parish, worship, sacred arts. These align with the Positive Keyword indicators in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (e.g., liturgy, sacred scripture, theology, chant, sacred music; reverence and wonder; imago Dei). The public materials repeatedly reference liturgy, orthodoxy, and church life, signaling high alignment with religious/metaphysical foundations.
- Negative keywords (from the Lexicon): relativism, secular humanism, value-neutral ethics. Not evidenced in the public materials; the materials emphasize absolute theological commitments and sacred practices.

Why this rating

- The presence of explicit theological framing, liturgical life, church-based formation, and sacramental worldview aligns solidly with Classical expectations in this category.

Citations: Orthodox church framing and liturgical life are described in the site materials (parish affiliation, liturgy, and worship practices).

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The mission and vision statements emphasize formation and virtue, not solely job readiness (e.g., “Education rooted in Orthodox Christian tradition,” “Education is formation,” and “Character is the curriculum”).
- Public materials explicitly phrase the aim as cultivating wisdom and virtue within a liberal-arts framework; mentions of keeping the faith and forming Orthodox Christian leaders.
- The school emphasizes formation over mere information (e.g., “Character is the curriculum” and a focus on long-term character and vocation within the church body).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords found: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos (implied in “goal” language), true/good/beautiful (inferred through “timeless truths” and “Encounter the Classics” phrasing), human flourishing, vocation, moral imagination.
- Negative keywords: workforce preparation, job readiness, 21st-century skills, test-driven metrics. Not present as primary aims; the emphasis remains on formation and virtue.

Why this rating

- The school's stated aims center on formation, virtue, wisdom, and faith-based leadership rather than primarily on career preparation or standardized-test outcomes, aligning with Classical expectations for purpose and goal.

Citations: Mission/formation language and faith-based aims are described on About/Overview materials.

Element 3: Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum is framed as "Liberal Arts" with emphasis on grammar, logic, and rhetoric; "Become a Language Artist" explicitly mentions grammar, logic, and rhetoric. Ancient Greek immersion is described in the high school program.
- The school uses "Encounter the Classics," highlighting engagement with classic works and careful reading; students are invited into critical conversations.
- History is studied across the curriculum with emphasis on narrative and civilization's story; literature, nature studies, and primary-source-informed work are present. The Academics page and program descriptions emphasize primary texts, classical authors, and integrated humanities.
- The school speaks of "the liberal arts" as a framework—Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and additional classical components (Greek immersion; study of saints and Church Fathers; primary sources).

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords found: liberal arts, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Great Books, classical curriculum, Trivium, Quadrivium, ancient Greek, primary sources, great conversation, history as Western civilization, integrated humanities, sacred/Church Fathers.
- Negative keywords: social studies terminology replacing history; project-based or experiential-dominant learning (not present as primary in the public materials). The materials emphasize classical texts and integrated study rather than modern purely project-based pedagogy.

Why this rating

- The explicit presence of the seven liberal-arts frame (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Greek immersion), engagement with classics, and integrated humanities strongly aligns with CLASSICAL curriculum expectations.

Citations: Curriculum descriptions (Academics, About, and firecrawl materials) show Liberal Arts emphasis, grammar/logic/rhetoric, and ancient Greek immersion.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Socratic discussion is explicitly referenced for upper grades (Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates; use of logic). This is a core Classical pedagogy element for higher grades.
- The school maintains a strong ritual/communal component (weekly liturgy and choir) that shapes memory, ethics, and formation, which aligns with scholé-like and contemplative elements but is not exclusively "restful learning" in the classical sense.
- The curriculum emphasizes rhetoric and public speaking or rhetorical practice in upper grades; the site describes a classical curriculum oriented toward language arts and debate.
- There is strong evidence of two distinct modalities: a liturgical, communal rhythm (weekly worship, sacred arts) and high-school Socratic/seminar-style inquiry. The presence of liturgical life (which is not a standard "pedagogy method" in all classical models) reduces the purity of a purely Socratic model, placing it in a blended, somewhat classical category.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords present: Socratic discussion, seminars, rhetoric, oratory, debate, memory work, recitation (labeled in the Classical Lexicon as appropriate upper-level pedagogy), chanting/singing as a memory aid, □□ approaches that emphasize classical dialogue and memory.
- Negative keywords present: experiential learning-focused, project-based learning dominant (not described as the sole or primary pedagogy here); restful scholé days are not emphasized across the public materials (though some contemplation exists through liturgical life).

Why this rating

- Pedagogy shows strong classical components (Socratic discourse and rhetoric) but is blended with liturgical and communal practices that are not purely pedagogical methods. This hybrid yields a SOME-WHAT CLASSICAL rating in pedagogy.

Citations: Socratic/dialectic references (upper grades) and the presence of liturgical/choir activities (which shape pedagogy through culture and memory).

Element 5: Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Leadership & Staff pages present a dedicated team of faculty, including a Chaplain (Fr. Turbo Qualls), a Director of Academics, and multiple teachers (e.g., Sister Glykeria, Sister Xenia, Sister Elizabeth, Ian Flowers, etc.), illustrating a living, engaged faculty aligned with the school's mission.
- The faculty is described as central to the school's identity (the living curriculum and core of the school) and as mentors in a parish-based context. While some phrasing like "portrait of a teacher" is in the knowledge lexicon, the Mount Tabor materials explicitly present teachers and staff as essential to formation, spiritual life, and academics.
- The presence of a parish priest as part of leadership indicates a close alignment between faculty, faith life, and student formation.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords found: mentor, living curriculum, teachers as core, role-models, professional formation, parish partnership, staff as guardians of faith and learning, collaborative faculty culture.
- Negative keywords: The lexicon's negative markers (e.g., "facilitators on the side," overly credential-focused metrics) do not appear in these materials; the faculty portrayal remains classical and mentor-centered.

Why this rating

- The explicit, mission-aligned faculty structure and the centrality of teachers to the school's formation mission fit the Classical ideal of the teacher as living exemplars and curriculum.

Citations: Leadership & Staff descriptions and mission framing are documented in staff/about materials.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school positions itself as parish-centered, with weekly worship that includes parents and students, signaling strong parental involvement and partnership with the church community.
- There are explicit invitations for parents to participate in liturgical life and school events, signaling co-teaching and co-formation beyond a consumer relationship.

- The Enrichment and Program materials describe spiritual formation and family involvement through readings and shared worship, aligning with parental formation and community engagement.

Positive/Negative Keyword Analysis

- Positive keywords found: partnership with parents, co-teaching, parental formation, parent involvement, liturgical year events, family liturgy alignment, open campus visits (where relevant grammar in the lexicon is used).
- Negative keywords: none evident on the public materials; no consumerist framing or minimal parental involvement is present.

Why this rating

- Clear evidence of parental partnership, parental formation opportunities, and an open, welcoming stance toward parent involvement aligns with classical expectations for Parents & Community.

Citations: About/Overview materials and weekly worship context.

What Would Move the Needle

- If the Pedagogy category remains the only somewhat-classical area (Element 4), the following needle-moving steps could push Pedagogy toward a fully Classical profile:
- Increase explicit articulation of classical pedagogy across all grades (e.g., explicit mention of memory work, recitation, narration, and Socratic seminars in lower grades as well as upper grades).
- Expand explicit Great Books/Great Conversation integration beyond wording in overview to concrete reading lists and seminar structures for K–12 (consistent naming of Great Books and Great Conversation on the site and in curricula).
- Clarify a more explicit, contemplative Scholé orientation in daily routines (e.g., dedicated “Scholé days” with explicit restfulness and reflective practices) and connect these to memory and virtue formation.
- Provide more detailed, public-facing rationale for why liturgical life and sacred music are integrated pedagogy rather than separate Christian life components, to show a fully integrated classical approach rather than a supplement.
- Increase public-facing evidence of formal classical pedagogy in lower grades (e.g., lower-grade Socratic-style inquiry and simple rhetoric practice) to demonstrate continuity of classical methods from K–12.

Citations: Pedagogy elements evidenced (Socratic discussion, private rhetoric/upper-grade focus) are described in the site materials.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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